

What Founder-Alpha Does — The Operator Console

Guide 6 of 6

TL;DR

This guide is the explainer for every other founder of *what founder-alpha* (the operator role) does *behind the scenes*. Most of this is not a UI you can click on as a general founder, but understanding it is essential to using the rest of the platform with confidence. Topics: the publication review queue, the quarterly methodology review week, source-standing review, the unified attention queue, deletion vs. retraction, roles and credentials, kill switches, live authorization, outreach drafts, the firm's self-evaluation surfaces (scoreboard, eval, post-mortem). Reading this guide will not give you access to these surfaces; it will give you a clear picture of the safety architecture every other guide refers back to.

You will need

- A signed-in Codex session. (You won't click much; you'll recognize the names.)
- Guides 1–5 read first, since this guide refers to surfaces introduced there.

This guide does NOT cover

- Routine triage of principles — Guide 2.
- How Currents, the Oracle, and Forecasts produce their normal output — Guides 3–5.

1 Why a separate operator role?

The firm runs on *separation of duties*. Any founder can upload material, browse the corpus, review conclusions, ask the Oracle, and read everything the firm publishes. A small number of actions — publishing to the public site, signing the quarterly methodology review, flipping kill switches, authorizing real-money trades, removing material the firm has cited publicly, managing roles and credentials — are concentrated in the operator role (“founder-alpha”).

This is a deliberate constraint, for three reasons.

- **Real-world consequences.** Publishing and trading touch the world outside the firm. Each of those gates wants a single accountable actor.
- **Cryptographic signing.** The firm signs its public publications and its quarterly review with private keys. Those keys live with the operator role, not in the web app, so signing is an explicit human action.
- **Concentration of risk.** Kill switches and live-bet authorization can lose money. They live on the surface that gets reviewed most carefully.

Throughout the rest of this guide, “founder-alpha” is the operator role. If you are a general founder, treat this guide as a map of what happens to your work after you hand it off.

2 Map of the operator surfaces

The operator surfaces are scattered across the Codex. The main ones:

- **Ops** — operations dashboards (scheduler health, ingestion toggles, error counts, retention).
- **Publication** — the publication review queue with the six-criteria checklist.
- **Methodology review week** — the quarterly five-day methodology review, with cryptographically signed daily summaries.
- **Source triage** — citation-chain triage when a source's standing changes.
- **Attention** — the unified attention queue.
- **Founder Currents, Forecasts operator** — per- opinion and per-prediction operator controls.
- **Admin, Founders, Account/API keys** — roles, credentials, deletion workflows.
- **Scoreboard, Eval, Post-mortem** — the firm's self-evaluation surfaces.
- **Social** — outreach drafts; the firm never auto-posts.
- **Rigor gate, Adversarial, Peer review** — the publishing-readiness gates.
- **Provenance, Cascade** — the audit and impact- analysis views.

[screenshot screenshots/06_operator_dashboard.png not yet captured — The operations dashboard, showing scheduler health and the state of each ingestion path.]

3 The operations dashboards

The operations card on the dashboard is the operator's first stop when something seems off. It shows:

- Each scheduler loop and its last successful cycle time.
- Recent error counts per loop.
- The state of each ingestion path (Currents X ingestion, the articles dispatcher, the forecasts pipeline).
- Auto-processing health (whether uploads sitting in `queued_offline` are being picked up).
- Embedding-backfill state.

The operator drills in through dedicated sub-pages for CI status, load metrics (request volume, latency percentiles, error rate per method), and retention policies in effect.

4 The publication review queue

Publication is the gate before any conclusion or article goes public. The queue advances through five states: `queued` → `in_review` → `needs_revision` → `declined` → `published`.

Each queue item presents a **checklist** founder-alpha works through before approving. The checklist captures:

- **Meta-analysis OK** — the conclusion's methodology profile has been read and is acceptable.
- **Adversarial engaged OK** — the adversarial cycle has run and the strongest objection has been reviewed (not just produced).

- **Clarity OK** — the conclusion is readable to a smart outsider.
- **No leakage OK** — the conclusion does not expose private uploads or quoted material from sources that aren't public.

Approving the item mints a permanent public version (with a slug and a version number — republishing bumps the version) and the workshop's ledger writes a cryptographic signature attached to the canonical hash of the payload. The Codex stores the signature; the signing keys never live inside the website.

[screenshot screenshots/06_publication_queue.png not yet captured — The publication review queue. Each row shows the conclusion summary, its source uploads, its adversarial status, the checklist state, and the approve / send-back / decline controls.]

This is the only path to the public site for a conclusion. If you, as a general founder, want your work to be considered for publication, you do it by pushing the conclusion forward in **Conclusions**; the operator then picks it up from the queue.

5 The methodology review week

Once a quarter, the firm runs a five-day exercise where founder-alpha walks the firm's recent work and writes a structured account of what the firm learned. Each day of the week:

- The workshop produces a draft body that summarizes the day's focus (e.g., "Monday: principles accepted this quarter and their domains of applicability").
- Founder-alpha edits the body and writes the final account.
- When founder-alpha signs the day cryptographically, the row becomes immutable. To revise after signing, founder-alpha must clear the signature first — which is itself an audited event.

The history page shows every prior week's signed daily summaries. This is the firm's durable record of methodological self-assessment. As a general founder, you can read it; you cannot author it.

6 Source standing and source triage

When an outside source the firm has cited changes its public status (retraction, correction, dispute, expiration), the workshop fires a source-standing event. The standing change cascades into one triage row per affected conclusion, which lands on **Source triage**.

For each row founder-alpha:

- `confirm` — the source change applies; the cited conclusion needs revision.
- `override` — the operator believes the source change does not affect the conclusion. The override is logged.
- `dismiss` — the row is closed without action.

A separate trigger for the same surface is a citation-verdict — an NLI judge has decided that the way the firm cited a source (SUPPORTS, CONTRADICTS, QUALIFIES, MENTIONS) does not match what the source actually says. Mismatches block publication of new conclusions that depend on the affected citation.

7 The unified attention queue

Attention is one page that pulls together everything the system thinks an operator should look at: principles awaiting triage, drift events, contradictions, source-triage rows, decay items, publication-

review needs-revision rows, methodology-review-week days, and unanswered critiques.

Each row supports `snooze`, `dismiss`, and `unsnooze`. The actions are append-only so the queue's history is itself auditable.

As a general founder you will see attention items on your dashboard when they affect material you produced; the unified operator queue is operator-only.

8 Deletion vs retraction

Two adjacent flows; understand the difference because both can affect material you've worked on.

- **Deletion** — removal of source material. Soft-deletes the upload; all derived bridge rows are hard-deleted, and any conclusion left with zero sources is then hard-deleted too. The public surface stops resolving the affected rows. Used for: user / subject deletion requests; legal or compliance reasons. Performed by founder-alpha on the admin surface.
- **Retraction** — removal of a *published* output. The retraction is itself a published artifact: it creates a new public version that retracts the previous one, leaving an audit trail. Used for: an article or conclusion the firm no longer endorses. Performed by founder-alpha on the publication surface.

A retraction is a stance. A deletion is a removal of evidence. The firm makes the distinction visible because deleting evidence quietly is the easiest way for an audit trail to become useless.

9 Roles and the founders roster

The firm has three roles: `admin` (the founder-alpha operators), `founder` (general founders — everyone reading this), and `viewer` (read-only).

Founders are never hard-deleted. If a founder leaves the firm, their row stays, with all relations preserved, so that revision events, attributed conclusions, and public-reply consent records remain intact for audit.

Signup is intentionally not exposed. New founders are seeded by administrators. There is no “sign up” button anywhere on the public site.

10 Credentials and machine-to-machine keys

Machine-to-machine credentials — the kind the desktop apps use to talk to the Codex on behalf of a founder — are managed centrally. When you install Dialectic and sign in with your firm email and password, Dialectic gets a credential back from the Codex through a dedicated app-login endpoint. You never see or paste a key.

API keys for third-party integrations (CLIs, internal scripts, etc.) are minted by founder-alpha on the operator surface, with each key shown once in plaintext at mint time and the rest of the time stored only as a bcrypt hash. Revoking a key is also an operator action.

This is why the platform doesn't have a “mint your own API key” flow for general founders: the firm wants a single accountable place where machine credentials are issued and revoked.

11 Kill switches

There is no global kill switch. There are several precise ones, and that is deliberate. Each disables one specific risky surface:

- **Currents ingestion off.** The next scheduler cycle writes no new events. Existing opinions stay up.

- **Articles dispatcher off.** Existing articles stay up; no new ones are clustered or written.
- **Master live-trading off.** The platform-wide live-bet flag. This is gate 5 of the eight-gate contract (Guide 5). Setting it off refuses every downstream submit.
- **Per-submit kill switch.** Gate 8. Re-checked immediately before each order placement; trips even bets that already passed operator confirmation.

A general founder may notice the consequences of any of these (no new Currents opinions; no new bets) on the dashboard. The toggles themselves are operator-only.

12 Live authorization, revoked

The inverse of gates 6–7 in Guide 5. Founder-alpha can:

- **Revoke per-prediction authorization.** The row drops out of the public grid.
- **Cancel an open order before fill.** For exchanges that permit cancel, the operator UI exposes a cancel button on the position row.
- **Close an existing position.** The portfolio view has a manual close action. This is a real-funds action; it is gated behind the same confirmation modal as opening a bet.

13 Rigor gate, peer review, adversarial

These are the publishing-readiness gates that sit just before the publication review queue:

- **Rigor gate** — the per-publication audit that enforces the firm’s quantitative-formalisation contract: every approved principle-shaped conclusion must declare a null hypothesis, at least one metric, and at least one test. The gate refuses publication if any of these is missing.
- **Peer review** — the queue where founders cross-review each other’s conclusions before they enter the publication queue. Peer review is the only operator-adjacent surface general founders contribute to directly: if founder-alpha asks you to peer-review a colleague’s conclusion, this is where you do it.
- **Adversarial** — the founder-side view of the adversarial cycle’s output. An operator can apply a human override when the system’s verdict needs correction.

14 Outreach drafts

Social contains the operator-drafted outreach threads that go out to external replicators, journalists, and collaborators. The page generates a draft from the firm’s recent public material; the operator edits and either posts manually or exports for sending through a separate channel.

Preview — partially shipped

Automated sending is not enabled. Today, the outreach surface is a draft generator plus a send-when-I-say-so review queue. The Codex never directly posts.

15 Scoreboard, eval, post-mortem

Three closely related surfaces that record how the firm grades itself:

- **Scoreboard** — the firm's calibration performance, the same numbers that drive the public calibration manifest, but broken down by method, by domain, and by reviewer.
- **Eval** and per-run pages — the firm's evaluation runs against external batteries (e.g., forecasting tournaments, replication-public sets). Each run carries its corpus bundle, the predictions produced, the resolutions observed, Brier and log-loss, expected calibration error, and coverage.
- **Post-Mortem** — the post-mortem ledger: when the firm made a mistake, what the mistake was, what the cause was, and what was changed.

These are operator surfaces only in the sense that founder-alpha authors entries on them. As a general founder, you can read them, and in some cases your work will be cited as part of the audit.

16 Provenance and cascade

Provenance is the global view of the firm's audit graph: which method invocation produced which artifact, which artifact depends on which other artifact, which external sources fed the chain.

Cascade (`/cascade/<conclusionId>`) is the per-conclusion impact-analysis view (covered in Guide 2 from the founder side).

17 The reason for all this ceremony

It is fair to ask why the firm builds in so many gates, queues, and signatures when most days nothing goes wrong. The answer is the same answer that animates the whole platform: *Theseus's product is its recorded reasoning, not its opinions.*

That product is only worth anything if a later reviewer can inspect the record and trust what they see. Publication review, methodology signing, source-standing triage, deletion-vs-retraction, kill switches, live-bet gates — all of it exists so the record is trustworthy when it matters most. The work of founder-alpha is mostly invisible; what's left behind is what makes the firm credible when something does go wrong.

18 The one-page checklist when something is wrong

(For founder-alpha's reference, in the unlucky event you need to do this yourself.)

1. Look at the dashboard. Is the operations card red? What does the red text say?
2. Run the relevant non-writing diagnostic before flipping any switch.
3. If a kill switch is the right answer, flip the most specific one. Do not disable broader surfaces than you need to.
4. Restart the affected service with the documented helper script; do not stop the entire stack.
5. Once stable, file a critique so the failure has a written record. The post-mortem ledger picks it up.

19 Where the docs are

- The other five guides in this series.
- Operator-only runbooks: the scheduler operations reference, the Currents operator notes, the forecasts founder-alpha runbook, and the threat model. These live in the firm's internal docs and are not bundled with this user-guide series.

Where to read next

This is the last of the six guides. The next reading depends on which role you're in.

For a general founder: re-read Guide 1 and 2; install Dialectic; upload a few of your favorite essays; let the system work; come back to your dashboard in a week.

For founder-alpha: the operator runbooks live in the firm's internal docs (under docs/operations/ and docs/operator/ in the monorepo).

For everyone: the next scheduled task you should set up is a weekly fifteen-minute slot for principle triage (Guide 2) and a daily one-minute glance at the dashboard. That's the routine that keeps the firm's working memory fresh.